

Cayley-Hamilton theorem

Basic skills

Q1. For M $|M - \lambda I| = 0$ is the characteristic equation

Q2. a) $M = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$ $|M - \lambda I| = 0$

↑ subtract λ on leading diag

$$\Rightarrow \begin{vmatrix} 2-\lambda & 1 \\ 0 & 2-\lambda \end{vmatrix} = 0 \Rightarrow (2-\lambda)^2 = 0$$

b) $M = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 3 \\ 1 & 5 \end{pmatrix}$ $|M - \lambda I| = 0$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{vmatrix} -1+\lambda & 3 \\ 1 & 5-\lambda \end{vmatrix} = 0 \Rightarrow (-1+\lambda)(5-\lambda) - 3 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow -\lambda^2 + 6\lambda - 5 - 3 = 0 \Rightarrow \lambda^2 - 6\lambda + 8 = 0$$

c) $M = \begin{pmatrix} 5 & 1 & 4 \\ 0 & 4 & -1 \\ 2 & 6 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$ $|M - \lambda I| = 0$

$$\text{AS } \begin{vmatrix} 5-\lambda & 1 & 4 \\ 0 & 4-\lambda & -1 \\ 2 & 6 & -2-\lambda \end{vmatrix} = (5-\lambda) \begin{vmatrix} 4-\lambda & -1 \\ 6 & -2-\lambda \end{vmatrix} - \begin{vmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 2 & -2-\lambda \end{vmatrix} + 4 \begin{vmatrix} 0 & 4-\lambda \\ 2 & 6 \end{vmatrix}$$

$$\Rightarrow (s-\lambda)((4-\lambda)(-2-\lambda)+6) - (0+2) + 4(0-2(4-\lambda)) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow (s-\lambda)(\lambda^2 - 2\lambda - 2) - 2 - 8(4-\lambda) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow -\lambda^3 + 7\lambda^2 - 8\lambda - 10 - 34 + 8\lambda = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow -\lambda^3 + 7\lambda^2 - 44 = 0 \Rightarrow \lambda^3 - 7\lambda^2 + 44 = 0$$

Q3. $M^2 - 6M + 3I_2 = 0$

a) $M^2 = 6M - 3I_2$

b) $M^5 = M^2 M^3 = 6M^4 - 3M^3$

c) For M^{-1} need I_2 so

$$I_2 = \frac{6M - M^2}{3} = 2M - \frac{1}{3}M^2$$

Then $M^{-1} = M^{-1}I_2 = M^{-1}(2M - \frac{1}{3}M^2)$

$$= 2I_2 - \frac{1}{3}M$$

As $M^{-1}M = I_2$

Q4. $M = \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 5 \\ -1 & 4 \end{pmatrix}$

a) $|M - \lambda I| = 0 \Rightarrow \begin{vmatrix} 6-\lambda & 5 \\ -1 & 4-\lambda \end{vmatrix} = 0$

so $(6-\lambda)(4-\lambda) + 5 = 0$

$\Rightarrow \lambda^2 - 10\lambda + 29 = 0$

so by Cayley-Hamilton (replace $\lambda \rightarrow M$)

$M^2 - 10M + 29I_2 = 0$

b) $\times M^{-1}$ to get $M - 10I_2 + 29M^{-1} = 0$

so $M^{-1} = \frac{1}{29} (10I_2 - M)$

$= \frac{1}{29} \left(10 \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} - \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 5 \\ -1 & 4 \end{pmatrix} \right)$

$= \frac{1}{29} \begin{pmatrix} 4 & -5 \\ 1 & 6 \end{pmatrix}$

Q5. $M = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 2 \\ 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix} \quad |M - \lambda I| = 0$

$$\Rightarrow -\lambda(-2-\lambda) - 2 = 0 \Rightarrow \lambda^2 + 2\lambda - 2 = 0$$

$$\text{SO } M^2 + 2M - 2I_2 = 0$$

$$\text{SO } I_2 = M + \frac{1}{2}M^2$$

$$\begin{aligned} \Rightarrow M^{-1} &= I_2 - \frac{1}{2}M = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} + \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 2 \\ 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ \frac{1}{2} & 0 \end{pmatrix} = \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 2 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Q6. } M = \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 5 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix} \quad |M - \lambda I| = 0$$

$$\begin{vmatrix} 6-\lambda & 5 & 0 \\ 0 & 2-\lambda & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -2-\lambda \end{vmatrix} = 0$$

↓ along column

$$\Rightarrow (6-\lambda) \begin{vmatrix} 2-\lambda & -1 \\ 1 & -2-\lambda \end{vmatrix} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow (6-\lambda) ((2-\lambda)(-2-\lambda) + 1) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow (6-\lambda) (\lambda^2 - 3) = 0 \Rightarrow -\lambda^3 + 6\lambda^2 + 3\lambda - 18 = 0$$

$$\text{SO } \lambda^3 - 6\lambda^2 - 3\lambda + 18 = 0$$

Then by Cayley-Hamilton

$$M^3 - 6M^2 - 3M + 18I_3 = 0$$

a) so $M^3 = 6M^2 + 3M - 18I_3$

so need

$$M^2 = \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 5 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 5 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 36 & 40 & -5 \\ 0 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$$

so $M^3 = 6 \begin{pmatrix} 36 & 40 & -5 \\ 0 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix} + 3 \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 5 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix} - 18 \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} 216 & 255 & -30 \\ 0 & 6 & -3 \\ 0 & 3 & -6 \end{pmatrix}$$

b) As $M^3 - 6M^2 - 3M + 18I_3 = 0$

$$\Rightarrow I_3 = \frac{1}{18} (6M^2 + 3M - M^3)$$

$$\text{so } M^{-1} = \frac{1}{18} (6M + 3I_3 - M^2)$$

$$\Rightarrow M^{-1} = \frac{1}{18} \left(6 \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 5 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix} + 3 \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} - \begin{pmatrix} 36 & 40 & -5 \\ 0 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \right)$$

$$= \frac{1}{18} \begin{pmatrix} 3 & -10 & 5 \\ 0 & 12 & -6 \\ 0 & 6 & -12 \end{pmatrix}$$

Advanced skills

Q7. $M = \begin{pmatrix} 7 & -1 \\ 8 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$

a) $|M - \lambda I| = 0 \Rightarrow (7 - \lambda)(2 - \lambda) + 8 = 0$
 $\Rightarrow \lambda^2 - 9\lambda + 22 = 0$ so $M^2 - 9M + 22I_2 = 0$

b) so $M^2 = 9M - 22I_2$

Then $M^n = M^2 M^{n-2} = 9M M^{n-2} - 22I_2 M^{n-2}$
 $= 9M^{n-1} - 22M^{n-2}$

Q8. M has $\lambda = -2, 3$ eigenvalues

a) so $|M + 2I| = 0$, $|M - 3I| = 0$

and $(\lambda + 2)(\lambda - 3) = 0 \Rightarrow \lambda^2 - \lambda - 6 = 0$

$$\text{So } M^2 - M - 6I_2 = 0$$

$$\text{So } M^2 - M = 6I_2$$

$$b) \text{ Let } M = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \Rightarrow M^2 = \begin{pmatrix} a^2 + bc & ab + bd \\ ac + cd & bc + d^2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\text{Then } \begin{pmatrix} a^2 + bc - a & ab + bd - b \\ ac + cd - c & bc + d^2 - d \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 0 \\ 0 & 6 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\text{So } a^2 - a + bc = 6$$

$$d^2 - d + bc = 6$$

$$ab + bd - b = 0$$

$$ac + cd - c = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow a^2 - a = d^2 - d$$

note. a=d works but not only

Solution

$$\text{also } b(a+d-1)=0, c(a+d-1)=0$$

$$\text{So } a = 1-d \text{ or } b = c = 0$$

$$\text{and if } a = 1-d \text{ then } (1-d)^2 - (1-d) = d^2 - d$$

$$\Rightarrow d^2 - 2d + 1 - 1 + d = d^2 - d$$

true for all d.

So not unique

$$a = -2, d = 3$$

$$b = c = 0$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} -2 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\text{or } a = 3, d = -2$$

$$b = c = 1$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$$

Q9. using $M = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}$

$$\text{Then } |M - \lambda I| = 0 \Rightarrow (\lambda - a)(\lambda - d) - bc = 0$$

$$\text{So } \lambda^2 - (a+d)\lambda + ad - bc = 0$$

$$\text{So show } M^2 - (a+d)M + (ad - bc)I_2 = 0$$

$$M^2 = \begin{pmatrix} a^2 + bc & ab + bd \\ ac + cd & bc + d^2 \end{pmatrix}$$

So

$$\begin{pmatrix} a^2 + bc & ab + bd \\ ac + cd & bc + d^2 \end{pmatrix} - (a+d) \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} ad - bc & 0 \\ 0 & ad - bc \end{pmatrix}$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} a^2+bc & ab+bd \\ ac+cd & bc+d^2 \end{pmatrix} - \begin{pmatrix} a^2+ad & ba+bd \\ ac+dc & ad+d^2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$+ \begin{pmatrix} ad-bc & 0 \\ 0 & ad-bc \end{pmatrix}$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} a^2+bc & ab+bd \\ ac+cd & bc+d^2 \end{pmatrix} - \begin{pmatrix} a^2+bc & ba+bd \\ ac+dc & d^2+bc \end{pmatrix}$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \text{ AS required.}$$